

Despite the overall excellence of the generation quality, the model can only perceive the seed context and hallucinate what to generate based on the limited knowledge (100M tokens only) it is trained on. As a result, the generated text sometimes looks clearly relevant but not close enough or to the point compared to what human writer would do. That said, we believe this issue is mostly a problem of limited training data size and could be alleviated by using a larger training set.

Context:

Kershaw started the 2010 season by posting a 3.07 ERA in April, but did so by walking 22 batters in 29 innings. On May 4, he had his worst start of his career against the Milwaukee Brewers at Dodger Stadium, throwing just 57 pitches in 11 / 3 innings, while retiring only four of the 13 batters he faced — including the pitcher. He was booed loudly upon being pulled from the game. Kershaw said after the game, " I didn't give our team any kind of chance. It's just not a good feeling to let your teammates down, let everybody down. It stings, it hurts. I've got to figure things out. " Kershaw rebounded his next start by pitching an 8 inning two-hitter and out-dueling the then undefeated Ubaldo Jiménez. He credited his control of the slider being the major turning point for him. Later in the season, he was suspended for five games after hitting Aaron Rowand of the Giants with a pitch in a game on July 20. The incident occurred after both teams were given a warning following Giants ace Tim Lincecum hitting Matt Kemp earlier in the game. He threw his first career complete game shutout on September 14, 2010 also against San Francisco and finished the season with a record of 13 – 10 and a 2.91 ERA in 32 starts, pitching 2041 / 3 innings and recording 212 strikeouts.

===== 2011 season: 1st Cy Young Award =====

After finishing the 2010 season strong, the Dodgers named Kershaw as the Opening Day Starter for the 2011 season. On May 29, he pitched the second complete-game shutout of his career, striking out 10 while winning a two-hitter against the Florida Marlins, 8 – 0; he also had two singles and an RBI, scoring twice in the game. He produced his third career shutout on June 20, a two-hit, 11-strikeout effort against the Detroit Tigers. Kershaw became the first Dodgers starter to strike out the side in the 9th inning since Sandy Koufax's perfect game. In his next start, on June 26, Kershaw pitched another complete game (against the Los Angeles Angels of Anaheim). He became the first Dodger starter to have back-to-back complete game victories since Jeff Weaver in the 2005 season and the first Dodger to have double-digit strikeouts in consecutive starts since Chan-Ho Park in the 2000 season. He was awarded the National League Player of the Week award for the week of June 20 – 26 as a result of those two starts. Midway through June, Kershaw had amassed 32 career victories

XL Generation:

, tying him with Luis Castillo for the third best start total in the league and trailing only Johnny Bench and Eddie Mathews (37). The Dodgers signed Kershaw to a one-year deal on July 14, 2011, with a player option for 2012, in a deal worth just under \$ 300,000. The Dodgers entered the 2011 season as the major league leaders, and Kershaw had the best record in the National League in saves (39), games started (78) and walks (120); he also had the lowest win / loss ratio in the league (1.87), and he had the worst on-base percentage (.349). He had the best ERA (2.00), most wins (16), or most shutouts (29) in his career (25), while leading the league in losses per nine innings pitched (4.01). Following the 2011 season, the Dodgers traded Kershaw to the Kansas City Royals on July 29 for pitcher Javier Torres.

===== Kansas City Royals =====

===== 2012 season =====

During spring training, Kershaw played very well. He was selected to spring training as a relief pitcher for the Royals for the 2012 season. After an injury to closer Javier Vázquez, he was activated on April 29 to replace Matt Holliday in the Royals ' starting rotation. In his only start with the Royals, on August 6, 2012, Kershaw struck out five batters in seven innings pitched to help the Royals to their first victory in franchise history. On September 27, 2012, it appeared Kershaw was going to pitch a complete game shutout against the Detroit Tigers, but did not manage to do so since the Tigers won 3 – 1. At the conclusion of the season, Kershaw was named Major League Baseball's Most Valuable Player, was chosen to the All-Star Game at Busch Stadium and was named to the All-Star Game as the starting pitcher at shortstop. The Royals announced on February 4, 2013 that Kershaw would spend 2013 as starting pitcher, though he was expected to miss the season as a result of a shoulder injury.

===== 2013 season =====

On May 17, 2013, Kershaw sustained another back injury and did not start in August and October 2013. He appeared in 22 starts, all starts, finishing with a strikeout-to-walk ratio of 1.50 and a 2.91 ERA. He also had the third most strikeouts in the league: 10. On May 20, 2013, he

Reference:

, a 3.15 ERA and 593 career strikeouts in 568.2 innings. According to the Elias Sports Bureau, Kershaw was the first 23-year-old pitcher to have that many victories, an ERA that low and an average of more than one strikeout per inning since ERA became an official statistic in 1910. Kershaw was selected to the National League team for the 2011 Major League Baseball All-Star Game, his first All-Star selection. In the month of July, Kershaw was 4 – 1 with a 2.02 ERA and NL-leading 45 strikeouts, earning him the National League Pitcher of the Month Award. On August 23, he struck out Matt Holliday of the St. Louis Cardinals for his 200th strikeout of the season and became the 10th Dodger pitcher to record back-to-back 200 strikeout seasons and the first since Chan-Ho Park did it in the 2001 season. Kershaw finished the 2011 season by leading the NL with 21 wins, 248 strikeouts and a 2.28 ERA, winning the NL pitching Triple Crown, the first Triple Crown winner since Jake Peavy of the 2007 San Diego Padres and the first Dodger since Sandy Koufax won it in the 1966 season. Justin Verlander of the Detroit Tigers won the American League Triple Crown the same season, marking the first major-league season since 1924 to feature Triple Crown-winning pitchers in both leagues. Kershaw's 21 wins were the most by a Dodger pitcher since Orel Hershisier won 23 during the 1988 season. His ERA was the lowest by a Dodger since Hershisier's 2.03 in the 1985 season, his strikeouts were the most by a Dodger since Koufax's 317 in 1966 and his 233 1 / 3 innings pitched were the most since Chan Ho Park pitched 234 in 2001. Since 1965 when Koufax did it, Peavy and Kershaw are only two pitchers in the National League have led the league in wins, strikeouts, ERA, and WHIP (walks plus hits per inning pitched). Kershaw also became just the second <unk> to have a 240-plus strikeouts in a season before the age of 24, joining Vida Blue. After the season, Kershaw was awarded the Warren Spahn Award as the best left-handed pitcher in 2011, the Players Choice Award for Most Outstanding National League pitcher, the Gold Glove Award as the top fielding pitcher in the NL and the Sporting News (TSN) National League Pitcher of the Year. He was additionally selected as the starting pitcher for the TSN NL All-Star Team. On November 17, he was honored with the National League Cy Young Award, making him the youngest Cy Young winner since Dwight Gooden

Table 11: Example 1 – 500 tokens generated by XL using a snippet from the Wikitext-103 test set as initial context. The sample is randomly generated without any cherry picking.

Original Wikipedia page: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Clayton_Kershaw

There are many interesting observations from this example:

- Firstly, Kershaw never went to Royals in real life. Despite that, Transformer-XL stays on the fully imagined topic and keeps hallucinating the experience of Kershaw in Royals across the generated text.
- Secondly, notice that XL correctly tracks the chronological order from 2011 to 2012 and to the finally 2013 season in the section titles.
- In addition, notice that Transformer-XL accurately uses the the phrase “another back injury” in the 2013 season paragraph, since it has talked about one earlier injure in the 2012 season. This shows again Transformer-XL's ability of capturing long-term dependency.